



Assessment Policy

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Section 1 – Purpose

1. The purpose of this Student Assessment Policy at Maldives Polytechnic is to establish clear principles and processes for evaluating student learning while ensuring alignment with academic and professional standards. This policy promotes fairness, consistency, and transparency in assessment practices. It is designed to ensure that all assessment tasks effectively measure how well students have achieved the intended learning outcomes and skill requirements within a unit of study. Additionally, it provides guidance for teaching staff in making informed, objective decisions regarding student performance across disciplines.

Section 2 - Scope

2. This policy applies to all academic programs and courses offered by Maldives Polytechnic. It is relevant to students, academic staff, and individuals responsible for designing, administering, and making decisions related to assessment.

Section 3 - Principles

3. Assessments should be directly linked to the course's learning objectives, ensuring that they accurately measure students' attainment of the intended knowledge and skills.
4. Assessment processes should be equitable and transparent, providing all students with a clear understanding of expectations and criteria. This includes consistent application of assessment methods and unbiased evaluation.
5. Assessments should accurately measure what they are intended to and produce consistent results over time and across different evaluators.
6. Assessment tasks should be designed to engage students actively in their learning process, enhancing motivation and promoting deeper understanding.
7. Assessments should accommodate the diverse needs of all students, ensuring they are inclusive and accessible, and do not disadvantage any group.
8. Timely and constructive feedback should be provided to guide students' learning, helping them understand their progress and areas for improvement.
9. Assessment practices should promote honesty and integrity, deterring academic misconduct and fostering a culture of ethical scholarship.

10. Assessment data should be utilized to inform and enhance teaching practices, curriculum design, and overall educational quality.
11. Maldives Polytechnic is committed to fairness, inclusivity, and accessibility in assessment. All students, including those with Special Educational Needs (SEN), must be provided equitable opportunities to demonstrate their learning achievements. Reasonable accommodations will be made to ensure assessments are accessible while upholding academic standards.

Section 4 - Definitions

12. Learning Outcome - The form in which students demonstrate their learning and achievement of the aims of a module by undertaking an assessment task. Module Outlines contain a description of both the aims and learning outcomes of the module.
13. Academic Standard - A level of student learning that is assessed through specified learning outcomes and about which there is consensus within the relevant disciplinary community.
14. Assessment Criteria - The different aspects of an assessment task that are subject to separate assessment. Students are informed about the assessment criteria before they commence an assessment task.
15. Assessment Task - A task undertaken by students which requires them to demonstrate one or more of the learning outcomes of a module.
16. Award - Award means the professional doctorate, degree, diploma, or certificate awarded by an institution or a partner university to a student enrolled in the institution.
17. Constructive Alignment - The term used to describe the alignment of course aims, learning outcomes, assessment tasks, and assessment criteria.
18. Formative Assessment - Assessment where student performance does not contribute to their final mark or grade in the course. Formative assessment provides students with feedback on their learning.
19. Module - A module means a subject of scholarly study taught or researched at an institution:

20. Program - A program comprises a set of modules upon completion of which can lead to an award or a non-award.
21. Reliability - Reliability is the extent to which an assessment item is able to elicit the same response on successive occasions.

Section 5 - Guidelines for Assessments

22. The assessment process at Maldives Polytechnic must be carried out with careful attention to fairness, consistency, and alignment with the learning outcomes of each module. This includes ensuring that assessment tasks are clearly defined in the module outline and that they directly reflect the intended learning outcomes. Instructors are responsible for providing timely and constructive feedback to students, keeping accurate records of all assessments, and ensuring that grading is consistent through moderation processes. Quality assurance measures should be followed to maintain academic standards, and all parties involved must understand their roles and responsibilities in supporting a transparent and effective assessment process.

Learning Outcomes

23. Learning outcomes should be explicitly stated in the module outlines for each module at Maldives Polytechnic. Clearly defined learning outcomes provide both students and academic staff with a clear understanding of the expectations for the module. They serve as a foundation for designing assessment tasks, teaching methods, and content, ensuring that all elements of the module are constructively aligned to achieve the desired results. By aligning learning outcomes with the broader program objectives, students are better prepared to develop the necessary knowledge, skills, and attitudes required for their academic and professional success.

Learning outcomes should be

- a. aligned with assessment tasks, module content, and teaching methods, ensuring that all components work together to achieve the desired outcomes.
- b. encompass knowledge, skills, attitudes, and, where relevant, ethical values and professional conduct.

- c. derived from and connected to the objectives of the program to ensure that the module contributes meaningfully to the overall program goals.
- d. served as the criteria for evaluating student performance, helping instructors assess whether students have acquired the necessary competencies.

Assessment task

24. Assessment tasks should be designed to evaluate students against the specific learning outcomes of each module. Each student should be assessed independently, based on their own performance, using criterion-referenced assessments that align with the learning outcomes. The assessment tasks should be diverse, ensuring that they effectively measure different aspects of the learning process while supporting the overall development of students. A variety of assessment methods, including both individual and group tasks, should be used to provide a well-rounded evaluation of student learning.

- a. Assessment tasks should allow students to demonstrate the extent to which they have achieved the learning outcomes for the module.
- b. Assessment tasks should be diversified, taking into account the time required for completion, weightage towards the final grade, and the timing and sequence of the tasks to best support student learning.
- c. All assessment tasks should be valid and reliable indicators of student learning and aligned with the learning outcomes of the module.
- d. No single assessment task should carry more than 70% of the final grade, except for special modules approved by the Academic Board.
- e. Special mechanisms should be in place to ensure that at least 50% of the assessment tasks are completed in controlled environments.
- f. Each assessment task should address specific learning outcomes, with the complete set of tasks collectively covering all learning outcomes of the module.

- g. If collaborative work is required for an assessment task, a balance should be established between individual and group contributions.
- h. Participation in fieldwork, laboratory sessions, or industrial exposure should be considered when necessary to meet the learning outcomes of the module or program.
- i. Special considerations should be given for students facing valid circumstances, ensuring equal opportunities for all students.
- j. Students with disabilities should be provided with the necessary support to fully participate in assessment tasks.
- k. Supplementary assessments should be available for students who need a second chance to successfully complete the module.
- l. Before beginning an assessment task, students should be informed about how their performance will be evaluated for each assessment criterion.

Assessment Administration and Student Support

25. This section outlines the procedures and requirements related to assignment submission, late penalties, extensions, special consideration, and academic integrity. These provisions are designed to ensure fairness, consistency, and accountability while maintaining the standards of Maldives Polytechnic.

Assignment Submission

- a. All assignments must be typed and submitted in acceptable formats such as DOC, PPT, or PDF unless a specific format or form is prescribed by the lecturer.
- b. Students unable to submit within the given deadline due to a genuine reason must inform the respective faculty in writing at least 24 hours before the deadline. Requests must be submitted using the prescribed form and supported by relevant documentation (e.g., medical certificate).

Late Submission

- a. A deduction of 5% of the marks received will be applied for late submissions, with an additional 5% penalty for each subsequent day of delay, including holidays.
- b. Submissions more than 7 days after the deadline will not be accepted. The 7-day period excludes weekends and public holidays, and will be calculated from the exact deadline time.

Extensions and Special Consideration

- a. Extensions may be granted in cases of genuine and documented circumstances.
- b. Students must apply before the due date using the official Application for Extension form and provide valid supporting documentation, such as a medical certificate.
- c. Extensions are normally limited to a maximum of three working days, excluding weekends and public holidays.
- d. Requests beyond this period require a formal application for Special Consideration.
- e. Special consideration may be granted when students are unable to complete assessments due to prolonged illness or serious disruptions, upon written application to the Head of Department with relevant supporting documents.
- f. If approved, students may be permitted to complete a reassessment to ensure they are not disadvantaged.
- g. Students with Special Educational Needs (SEN) who are unable to meet assessment requirements due to their condition may apply for extensions or special consideration. Supporting documentation must be provided, and reasonable adjustments will be granted in consultation with institutional support services. These adjustments may include extended deadlines, alternative assessment formats, or rescheduling opportunities.

Academic Integrity

- a. All work submitted must be original and free from plagiarism, collusion, or any other form of academic misconduct.

- b. All referencing must follow the APA style guidelines.
- c. If the program is affiliated with another college or university, the referencing style required by that institution must be followed.
- d. Similarity detection software, such as Turnitin, should be used for assessment submissions where applicable to verify the originality of work.
- e. Assessments and examinations should be subject to invigilation, either in person or through digital tools, to safeguard the integrity of student work.
- f. Academic integrity risks within assessment design and delivery should be regularly monitored. Routine reviews should be conducted to implement improvements and integrate sector recommendations aimed at reducing academic integrity risks.
- g. Maldives Polytechnic should respond to suspected breaches of academic integrity in a fair, consistent, transparent, and timely manner, following the relevant policies.

Support for SEN Students

- a. Students with Special Educational Needs (SEN) will be given the support they need through adjustments such as extra time in exams, using assistive tools, having different formats of assessment (for example, oral instead of written), or being provided with a suitable environment for assessments.
- b. Academic staff are required to work with the designated support office to ensure that these measures are applied consistently, fairly, and with full respect for confidentiality.

Feedback

26. Students should receive timely and constructive feedback on their performance throughout the module. Feedback serves as a key tool for students to understand the extent of their learning, recognize areas for improvement, and identify strategies to enhance their performance. It should be provided in a manner that supports student development and encourages continuous improvement. Feedback should not only be restricted to formal assessment tasks but also include various formative assessments,

enabling students to track their progress and make necessary adjustments during the course.

- a. Feedback should provide students with information on what they have learned and how effectively they are progressing.
- b. Feedback should inform students of the standards of performance they have achieved in comparison to the expected learning outcomes.
- c. Feedback should guide students on what steps they need to take to improve their performance and meet the required standards.
- d. Feedback is not limited to final assessments but should also include formative assessments like self-assessments, peer assessments, in-class feedback, and examples of high-standard work.
- e. To maximize learning, lecturers should provide continuous feedback throughout the module to support student development.
- f. Feedback should be both qualitative and quantitative, except in the case of final examinations, where feedback will take the form of a grade.
- g. Students should have the opportunity to discuss the feedback received on assessments with the relevant faculty members to ensure clarity and understanding.

Grades

27. Grades should be recorded and assigned based on specified grade descriptors that reflect the level of student performance in an assessment task or overall module. These descriptors provide a standardized way of assessing student achievement against the expected learning outcomes of the module. Grades are a representation of how well students have met the module's objectives and provide a clear statement of their academic progress. They should be communicated transparently, with an explanation of how the final grade is derived from the marks and grades of individual assessments.

- a. Grades should be used as symbols to indicate the level of student performance in both individual assessments and the overall module.
- b. Overall student performance in a module is recorded as a mark and grade or a grade aggregated across individual assessment tasks, with the contribution of each task clearly explained in the module outline.
- c. Students should be shown their marks and grades for all assessment tasks, except for the final examination. In cases where only coursework assessments are involved, marks for the final assessment task will not be revealed.
- d. The final grade displayed at the end of the semester will represent the student's aggregate performance for the module.
- e. If students are required to pass all or specific assessment tasks to achieve a passing grade, they may receive a fail grade even if their aggregate score is a pass.
- f. In exceptional circumstances, the final mark of the module may be standardized, with specific procedures for mark standardization to be followed.
- g. Students have the right to appeal the grade received for any assessment task. For non-final assessments, students can write to the course coordinator within six working days of the result release for reconsideration or remarking.
- h. Students may also appeal against their final grade by submitting an application for reconsideration within six working days of the release of the results, and the final assessment task may be sent for remarking by a different examiner.
- i. Any public display of student results should only include the student's identification number and grade, ensuring privacy is maintained.

Moderation

28. Moderation should be carried out to ensure the academic standards of a module are consistently maintained, regardless of when or how the module is delivered. It plays a crucial role in ensuring fairness, transparency, and consistency in the assessment

process. Through moderation, academic staff involved in assessing student performance align their judgments to agreed standards, ensuring that all assessments are valid and reliable indicators of student achievement.

- a. Moderation involves a process where academic staff responsible for assessment reach consensus on the level of student performance in relation to established standards.
- b. The purpose of moderation is to maintain agreed standards in the assessment process by ensuring it is valid, consistent, and transparent.
- c. Moderation ensures that assessments accurately reflect student performance and align with the intended learning outcomes of the module.
- d. When multiple markers are involved in the assessment process, additional safeguards should be used to ensure the consistency and fairness of grading, as outlined in the moderation procedures.

Record Keeping

29. Record keeping should be implemented to maintain transparency, accountability, and accuracy throughout the assessment process. It is essential that records are kept systematically.

- a. Accurate records of individual student performance, progress, and summary statistical data for each module should be maintained.
- b. Records should demonstrate consistency and fairness in marking throughout the assessment process.
- c. Physical evidence of assessments should be kept for a minimum of six months after a student graduate from the program.
- d. All records should be maintained by the appropriate departments and kept accessible as needed.

Quality Assurance

30. Quality assurance should be carried out to ensure that assessments meet academic standards and are accurately aligned with institutional goals. It provides accountability for the assessment process.

- a. The Quality Assurance Committee and the Curriculum Committee should oversee the quality assurance of assessments.
- b. The Head of Department (HOD) together with the Manager of the School should ensure that assessment tasks meet academic standards before they are given to students.
- c. All assessment tasks should be reviewed and approved by the HOD and the Manager of the School to ensure alignment with agreed standards.
- d. At the end of each semester, the HOD and the Manager of the School should review and endorse final results before they are submitted to the Academic Board for approval.

Grading System

31. The grading system at Maldives Polytechnic is designed to assess student performance and align it with the learning outcomes of each module. The grades awarded should reflect the student's achievements and understanding of the material.

- a. **Grades:** The grades provided for student assessments are symbols that represent the level of achievement demonstrated in the assessment task or throughout the module.
- b. **Grade Descriptors:** The grading scale includes specific descriptors for each grade, from "High Distinction" to "Fail." These grades are determined based on the student's performance against the agreed assessment criteria and learning outcomes.
- c. Two grading systems are applied at Maldives Polytechnic:

1. **General Assessment Modules** – used in most academic programs.

- 2. Competency-Based Assessment Modules** – applied in specific programs where industry or professional requirements demand a higher standard of competency.

1. General Assessment Modules

This grading system applies to the majority of programs and modules at Maldives Polytechnic. Student performance is assessed through a combination of assignments, coursework, projects, and examinations. A minimum of **50%** is required to achieve a passing grade.

d. Marking Range: The marks corresponding to each grade are as follows:

- **HD (High Distinction):** 85-100
- **DN (Distinction):** 75-84
- **CR (Credit):** 65-74
- **PP (Pass):** 50-64
- **FC (Fail Conditional):** 45-49
- **FF (Fail):** 0-44
- **NE:** Not eligible to sit the exam due to low attendance.
- **XC:** Advanced Standing (credit transfer from another program).

Grades and Marking Range

LEVEL OF ACHIEVEMENT	EQUIVALENT MARKS RANGE	GRADE POINTS
HD - HIGHER DISTINCTION	85 - 100	4
DN - DISTINCTION	75 - 84	3
CR - CREDIT	65 - 74	2
PP – PASS	50 - 64	1
FC – CONDITIONAL FAIL (RE-SIT)	45 - 49	0
FF – UNSATISFACTORY (REPEAT)	0 - 44	0
XC (ADVANCED STANDING / CREDIT TRANSFER)	N/A	-

- e. Grade Points for CGPA Calculation: Each grade corresponds to a grade point used for the calculation of the Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA).

Illustrative Example of CGPA Calculation

#	Modules	Credit Point of the module	Grade the student got from the module	Grade Point	Total (Multiply Credit point of the module and the grade point she got)	GPA (Total divided by total of credit point of the module)	Rounded	Final Grade
1	Architectural Design Project 1	15	CR	2	30			
2	Environment & Culture 1	6	HD	4	24			
3	Architectural communication 1	12	PP	1	12			
4	Building Materials	12	PP	1	12			
5	Construction 1	12	CR	2	24			
6	English for Further Studies	9	DN	3	27			
7	Architectural Design Project 2	15	CR	2	30			
8	Architectural Communication 2	12	PP	1	12			
9	Environment & Culture 2	6	CR	2	12			
10	Architectural Technologies	12	PP	1	12			
11	Construction 2	12	PP	1	12			
12	English for Academic Purpose	9	CR	2	18			
13	Architectural Design Project 3	15	PP	1	15			
14	Environment & Culture 3	6	CR	2	12			
15	Architectural Communication 3	12	DN	3	36			
16	Building Service	12	PP	1	12			
17	Professional Practice	15	PP	1	15			
18	Project Management	12	PP	1	12			
TOTAL		204			327	1.602941176	2	CR

2. Competency-Based Assessment Modules

This grading system applies to some courses, such as Electrical and Electronic programs, where industry standards or professional requirements require students to achieve a higher level of competency. A minimum of **60%** is required to be considered competent.

Grades and Marking Range

LEVEL OF ACHIEVEMENT	EQUIVALENT MARKS RANGE	GRADE POINTS
HD - HIGHER DISTINCTION	90 - 100	4
DN - DISTINCTION	80 - 89	3
CR - CREDIT	70 - 79	2
PP – PASS	60 - 69	1
FC – CONDITIONAL FAIL (RE-SIT)	40 - 59	0
FF – UNSATISFACTORY (REPEAT)	00 - 39	0
XC (ADVANCED STANDING / CREDIT TRANSFER)	N/A	-

Competency Assessment Rules

- a. Students must achieve at least **6 points out of 10** in each key competency area to be deemed competent.
- b. Students scoring below 6 points in any competency may be reassessed during the 15-week course period.
- c. All competency reassessments must follow departmental guidelines and be properly documented.

Reassessment and Module Completion

32. Students who do not achieve the required pass mark may be given a second opportunity to demonstrate competency or repeat the module, depending on the grading system of the program.

1. General Assessment Modules

- a. Students who score between **45–49 (Fail Conditional, FC)** will be granted a reassessment opportunity, subject to conditions determined by the lecturer
- b. Reassessment may also be granted if a student fails to achieve the required **80% module completion** or if the lecturer deems it necessary to support the student's learning progress.
- c. Students who score **0–44 (Fail, FF)** will be required to repeat the module in order to meet course requirements.

2. Competency-Based Modules

- a. Students who score between **40–59 (Fail Conditional, FC)** may be granted a reassessment opportunity to demonstrate competency, subject to conditions set by the lecturer or program requirements.
- b. Students who score **0–39 (Fail, FF)** will be required to repeat the module in order to satisfy competency requirements.

3. General Provisions

- a. Reassessment dates will be communicated to students at least 10 days in advance.
- b. All reassessments must follow departmental guidelines and be properly documented.

Resubmitting In-Class/Written Assessments

- f. Students who submit assessments late or request resubmission should follow the following guidelines.
 - a. Resubmission is not allowed for late assignments unless otherwise specified.
 - b. Requests for resubmission must be made within seven working days of the return of the original assignment.
 - c. Any resubmitted work will be awarded a maximum grade of 50% (Pass). Special Consideration may also require resubmission in certain cases.

Assessment Appealing

- g. The assessment appeal process is designed to provide students with an opportunity to challenge assessment decisions in a fair and structured manner.
 - a. **Stage 1:** If a student disagrees with their assessment, they should first review the criteria and discuss the issue with the assessor. If the student still believes the assessment decision is incorrect, they can request a written explanation from the assessor within 5 working days.
 - b. **Stage 2:** If the student is still dissatisfied, they should lodge an appeal with the Head of Department within one week. The Head of Department will review the information provided by both the student and the assessor and provide a reconsidered decision within 5 working days.
 - c. **Stage 3:** If the student disagrees with the decision at Stage 2, they can appeal to an independent appeals panel. The panel, consisting of three members, will meet

within 10 days to discuss the appeal and reach a decision. The outcome of the panel's decision is final and will be communicated to the student within 5 working days.

Attendance Requirements

- h. Attendance is a crucial aspect of student success and academic performance at Maldives Polytechnic. Students are required to maintain a minimum attendance of 80% in all seminars, workshops, or lectures to be eligible to sit for the final exam.
 - a. If a student attends only 75% of the classes, they should apply for Special Consideration, providing appropriate documentation to justify their absence (e.g., medical certificates). The student may also be required to complete additional work to compensate for the missed attendance.
 - b. Students should communicate with their lecturers regarding any absences and the circumstances affecting their attendance.

Responsibilities

- i. In order to maintain an efficient, transparent, and fair assessment process, clear roles and responsibilities must be assigned to all stakeholders involved. Each participant in the process has a critical role to ensure the success and integrity of the assessment system. The following outlines the specific responsibilities of the key stakeholders in the assessment process:
 - a. Course Coordinators should ensure that assessment tasks are properly aligned with the learning outcomes and grading criteria. They are also responsible for providing guidance and oversight to ensure the overall assessment process is carried out effectively and consistently throughout the semester. Course Coordinators must communicate any changes in the assessment process to both students and academic staff in a timely manner.
 - b. Academic Staff must adhere to all assessment policies and ensure that assessments are conducted according to established guidelines. They should design and grade assessment tasks fairly and consistently, provide timely

feedback to students, and ensure the assessment is conducted in a manner that reflects the learning outcomes of the module. Faculty members should also be available to discuss assessments and clarify any doubts students may have regarding grading criteria.

- c. Students are responsible for understanding the assessment criteria and requirements. They should ensure that their work is original, adhere to academic integrity standards, and seek clarification from academic staff if they are unclear about any aspect of the assessment. Students are also responsible for submitting their work on time and following the required submission processes.
- d. Moderators should ensure that the assessments are consistent and fair across different assessors. They should review sample student work and ensure that grading standards are applied uniformly. Moderators should also resolve any discrepancies or concerns about grading and provide guidance to academic staff when necessary.
- e. HODs and School Managers should oversee the quality and standards of all assessments across modules. They are responsible for ensuring that the assessment tasks align with the overall objectives of the program and that the assessments accurately reflect the student learning outcomes. The committee should monitor the effectiveness of the assessments and propose improvements based on feedback and best practices.

Section 6 - Review and Update

- j. This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure its effectiveness, relevance, and alignment with institutional goals, national standards, and best practices. This review will involve gathering feedback from academic staff, students, industry partners, and accreditation bodies to identify areas for improvement and ensure that assessment practices remain fair, transparent, and consistent with current educational trends.